

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
♥ Q J 9 6 3
♦ Q 8 4
♣ K 10 5 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8

♦ A K 7 3

♣ 9 8 6 2



♠ K Q 5

♥ K 10 4

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ J 7 4

♠ J 9 8 6 4 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 6 2

♣ A Q

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by North

Don't get too optimistic too early. If you play ♠A and another ♠ you could go down. Remember that you only counted one ♥ loser - that means you MUST ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Win the ♦ lead and play ♥A and another ♥ before you touch trumps.

After this there is nothing the defense can do to stop you ruffing one ♥ in your hand.

Just suppose for an instant that you had played ♠A and another.

East would have taken the second ♠, then pulled your last ♠. When the ♣ finesse failed you would make only 8 tricks.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♠.

Partner now bids 3♠.

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Partner now bids 3♠.

Partner tells you that he has only invitational strength, but has at least 6 ♠s. The ♠s are fine by you, but with only 15 HCP you decide to pass.

North plays 3♠. East leads the ♦J. UhOh. Maybe you should have bid game.

Loser List: ♠ = ? : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = ?

If the ♠s are 2-2 there will be only one loser in that suit. And maybe the ♣ finesse will work.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 8 6 3

♥ 6 2

♦ K 7 3

♣ K 6 2

♠ J 9 5 2

♥ Q J 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 10 9 7 4

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♠ A 10

♥ K 7 4 3

♦ A 6 5 4

♣ A Q 5

♠ 7 4

♥ A 10 9 8

♦ Q J 10 8

♣ J 8 3

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 8

With 12 points and a 5-card Major you transfer partner to that Major. You bid 2♥. Partner bids 2♠. Now what do say next?

With 12 points and a 5-card Major you transfer partner to that Major. You bid 2♥. Partner bids 2♠. Now what do say next?

You must insist on game, but since partner could have a doubleton ♠ you do so by bidding 3NT to give him the choice.

He chooses 3NT by passing.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♦Q. Do you win the first trick or holdup?

A holdup wouldn't hurt you since South would retain the lead. But it probably wouldn't help you much either since you do have 2 stoppers in the suit. You obviously need to establish at least one more winner in ♠s so you won't have to depend on the ♥A being with North. Need it be said that ♥s is the suit you are worried about and North is the Danger hand? Let's say you win the first trick with dummy's ♦K.

Suppose you play ♠A, then ♠K Q. If they split 3-3 you will be soooo happy because you will make at least 10 tricks. But if North shows out on the third ♠ you will be pretty happy because you can give up a ♠ to South and still make at least 9 tricks. But if South shows out on the third ♠ you could be in deep trouble. You would have to give North the lead to establish an extra ♠ winner, and he might very well lead through your ♥K.

There is a great safety play to protect against a 4-2 ♠ split. Play a low ♠ from dummy and finesse the ♠10. South may win with a doubleton ♠J but you will still make the contract.

With this layout the safety play finesse actually works and you make an overtrick.

But visualize the ♠J and ♠7 transposed. If you don't make the safety play it is true that the ♠J will fall. BUT, North will still take the fourth ♠ and when he gets in he will return the ♥Q.